

D235

Interprofessional Communication and Leadership in Healthcare

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A nurse on night shift at a hospital with a new cafeteria calls a physician about a patient whose blood pressure dropped to 82/50. She has introduced herself and the patient and stated the concern. The physician is known to be brisk. What comes next in SBAR?

- A. Background: relevant history, diagnosis, and recent treatments
- B. Recommendation: what she wants the physician to do
- C. Assessment: what she thinks is happening
- D. Skip straight to the request, because the physician is brisk

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In SBAR, a nurse says, “I think the patient may be bleeding internally.” Which part is this?

- A. Situation
- B. Assessment
- C. Recommendation
- D. Background

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

During a code on a unit with 24 beds, the leader says, “Give 1 mg epinephrine IV now.” The nurse, who transferred from the ED last month, draws it up. What completes closed-loop communication?

- A. She skips the repeat-back because of her ED experience.
- B. She repeats back “1 mg epinephrine IV,” gives it, and says “1 mg epinephrine given”; the leader acknowledges.
- C. She repeats back only the drug name.
- D. She gives it silently so the team isn’t distracted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sequence is closed-loop communication?

- A.** Sender gives the message → receiver acts
- B.** Every message, including casual chat, must be repeated back
- C.** Sender gives the message → receiver repeats it back → sender confirms
- D.** Receiver repeats back → sender gives the message

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A nurse at a surgical center with new lighting sees the team about to start without confirming the correct implant. She raised it once and was brushed off. The surgeon is chief of staff. What should she do next?

- A.** Stay silent because of the surgeon's rank.
- B.** Leave the room.
- C.** Raise it a second time using CUS — "I'm concerned; this is a safety issue" — and escalate if still ignored.
- D.** Stay quiet now and file an incident report later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A patient on a rehab unit with a new gym needs help relearning to dress and bathe after a stroke. The patient's family brings flowers daily. Which team member's role fits best?

- A.** Speech-language pathologist
- B.** The nurse alone, since nurses cover all care needs
- C.** Physical therapist
- D.** Occupational therapist

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student in an online program who works full-time and has two kids fails her first practice quiz and says, "I'm just not smart enough for this." Which response reflects a growth mindset?

- A. "Don't worry — you're naturally gifted."
- B. "Quit your job, since your workload caused this."
- C. "Some people just aren't academic."
- D. "Your score shows what to practice next; new strategies and effort build the skill."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which belief reflects a fixed mindset?

- A. "Mistakes show me what to learn next."
- B. "If something is hard for me, I'm just not good at it."
- C. "Challenges are chances to get better."
- D. "Asking for help is part of learning."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student who studies at a coffee shop with free Wi-Fi sets a goal for her first term. Her roommate is also a student. Which goal is SMART?

- A. Never miss a single day of studying.
- B. Do my best this term.
- C. Finish my degree.
- D. Complete two courses by March 31 by studying 15 hours each week.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A peer mentor in a program with 5,000 students talks with a classmate who says she is overwhelmed balancing work and study. The mentor has a busy day. What shows active listening?

- A.** Paraphrase — “It sounds like work hours are squeezing your study time” — and ask what feels hardest.
- B.** Share a long story about her own busy term.
- C.** Check email while nodding, since the day is busy.
- D.** Offer a quick fix right away.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A nursing student who just adopted a puppy lists her tasks for today. Using the urgent/important matrix, which should she do first?

- A.** Shop for puppy toys.
- B.** Plan next month’s study schedule.
- C.** Submit a graded assignment due tonight.
- D.** Reply to jokes in the class group chat.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the urgent/important matrix, what should you do with tasks that are important but not urgent?

- A.** Schedule them.
- B.** Do them immediately.
- C.** Drop them, since they aren’t urgent.
- D.** Delegate them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A nurse on night shift ~~at a hospital with a new cafeteria~~ calls a physician about a patient whose blood pressure dropped to 82/50. She has introduced herself and the patient and stated the concern. ~~The physician is known to be brisk.~~ What comes next in SBAR?

Target word: next SBAR part **Decides:** Situation is done; Background follows.

A	Correct	B follows S.
B	Confusion set	R comes last.
C	Dropped element	Skips background.
D	Camouflage	The physician's manner doesn't change the structure.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

In SBAR, a nurse says, "I think the patient may be bleeding internally." Which part is this?

Target word: SBAR part from statement **Decides:** The nurse's interpretation of the problem.

A	Confusion set	Situation states the immediate concern and patient.
B	Correct	Her clinical judgment of what is happening.
C	Adjacent category	A recommendation asks for an action.
D	Confusion set	Background is history and context.

3. Answer B Concept 2

During a code ~~on a unit with 24 beds~~, the leader says, "Give 1 mg epinephrine IV now." The nurse, ~~who transferred from the ED last month~~, draws it up. What completes closed-loop communication?

Target word: closed-loop steps **Decides:** Repeat back, act, report completion.

A	Camouflage	Experience does not replace verification.
B	Correct	Every step of the loop is closed.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out dose and route.
D	Inverted operation	Silence leaves the loop open.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

Which sequence is closed-loop communication?

Target word: correct order **Decides:** Send → repeat back → confirm.

A	Dropped element	No verification.
B	Absolute language	Closed loop is for critical information.
C	Correct	Both parties verify the same message.
D	Inverted operation	Order reversed.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A nurse at a surgical center ~~with new lighting~~ sees the team about to start without confirming the correct implant. She raised it once and was brushed off. ~~The surgeon is chief of staff.~~ What should she do next?

Target word: speaking-up step **Decides:** A safety concern already raised once.

A	Camouflage	Rank does not override safety.
B	Adjacent category	Withdrawing does not address the risk.
C	Correct	The two-challenge rule and CUS exist for this.
D	Dropped element	Reporting afterward does not prevent harm.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A patient on a rehab unit ~~with a new gym~~ needs help relearning to dress and bathe after a stroke. ~~The patient's family brings flowers daily.~~ Which team member's role fits best?

Target word: right discipline **Decides:** Activities of daily living.

A	Adjacent category	SLP focuses on speech and swallowing.
B	Absolute language	Interprofessional care uses each discipline's expertise.
C	Confusion set	PT focuses on mobility and gait.
D	Correct	OT focuses on daily living tasks.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A student in an online program ~~who works full time and has two kids~~ fails her first practice quiz and says, "I'm just not smart enough for this." Which response reflects a growth mindset?

Target word: growth-mindset reply **Decides:** Ability grows with effort and strategy.

A	Adjacent category	Praising talent reinforces a fixed view.
B	Camouflage	Her circumstances don't decide the mindset question.
C	Inverted operation	That is a fixed mindset.
D	Correct	Frames failure as information.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which belief reflects a fixed mindset?

Target word: spot the fixed belief **Decides:** Ability seen as unchangeable.

A	Confusion set	A growth belief.
B	Correct	Treats difficulty as proof of fixed ability.
C	Inverted operation	The opposite of a fixed view.
D	Confusion set	A growth belief.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A student who studies ~~at a coffee shop with free Wi-Fi~~ sets a goal for her first term. ~~Her roommate is also a student.~~ Which goal is SMART?

Target word: SMART goal **Decides:** Specific, measurable, dated.

A	Absolute language	Not realistic or measurable as progress.
B	Dropped element	No measure or date.
C	Adjacent category	A long-range aim without a timeline for this term.
D	Correct	Specific, measurable, and time-bound.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A peer mentor ~~in a program with 5,000 students~~ talks with a classmate who says she is overwhelmed balancing work and study. ~~The mentor has a busy day.~~ What shows active listening?

Target word: active listening behavior **Decides:** Paraphrase and open question before advice.

A	Correct	Shows understanding and invites more.
B	Adjacent category	Shifts focus to the listener.
C	Camouflage	Divided attention is not active listening.
D	Dropped element	Skips understanding the problem.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A nursing student ~~who just adopted a puppy~~ lists her tasks for today. Using the urgent/important matrix, which should she do first?

Target word: first task **Decides:** Both urgent and important.

A	Camouflage	The new puppy does not make this a priority.
B	Confusion set	Important but not urgent — schedule it.
C	Correct	Urgent and important.
D	Adjacent category	Feels pressing but is not important.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

In the urgent/important matrix, what should you do with tasks that are important but not urgent?

Target word: action for quadrant **Decides:** Important, not urgent.

A	Correct	Protect time for them before they become urgent.
B	Confusion set	That is for urgent and important tasks.
C	Inverted operation	Important work should not be dropped.
D	Adjacent category	Delegation is for urgent but less important tasks.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SBAR	Situation → Background → Assessment → Recommendation; each part has a distinct job.	Skipping background or confusing assessment with recommendation.	“What comes next?” or “Which part is this?”
2	Closed-loop communication	Sender gives the message, receiver repeats it back, sender confirms; the receiver reports when done.	Acting silently or skipping the repeat-back when experienced.	A verbal order in a high-stakes moment.
3	Speaking up (CUS and two-challenge rule)	Voice a safety concern at least twice; if ignored, use CUS (“I’m Concerned, Uncomfortable, this is a Safety issue”) and escalate.	Staying silent because of rank, or only reporting afterward.	A concern already raised once and brushed off.
4	Interprofessional roles	Know each discipline’s scope: OT = daily living activities; PT = mobility and gait; SLP = speech and swallowing.	Mixing up OT and PT, or assuming nurses cover every need.	A specific functional need after illness.
5	Growth vs. fixed mindset	A growth mindset treats ability as developed through effort and strategy; a fixed mindset treats it as set.	Praising talent instead of effort and strategy.	A student’s reaction to failure.
6	SMART goals for learners	A goal is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.	Accepting vague or absolute goals.	Several goal statements.
7	Active listening	Give full attention, paraphrase what was heard, and ask open questions before advising.	Jumping to fixes or telling your own story.	A peer shares a problem.
8	Urgent/important prioritization	Do urgent and important tasks first; schedule important but not urgent; delegate urgent but not important; drop the rest.	Treating anything that feels pressing as top priority.	A task list and “do first.”

Course scope (public description): Interprofessional Communication and Leadership in Healthcare is designed to help students prepare for success in the online environment at Western Governors University and beyond. Student success starts with the social support and self-reflective awareness that will prepare them to handle the challenges of all academic programs. In this course, students will complete several individual assignments that are intended to give the student an opportunity to reflect on where they are and where they would like to be. The activities in the course are designed to give students several tools they can use to achieve success. This course is designed as a four-part intensive learning experience. Students will engage in activities that will help them understand their own educational journey and find support and inspiration in the journey of others. There are no prerequisites for this course.